MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation & Test Infrastructure
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, with the last two focused largely on CI/CD pipelines, test environments, and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and namespace-level Kubernetes test environments for three product teams. Builds ephemeral environments with Helm and Docker, and has personal hands-on experience with k3s, GitOps, Terraform, and observability tooling. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Argo CD
Infrastructure as code and cloud: Terraform (personal project), Hetzner VPS (personal), AWS EC2 and S3 (basic, personal learning)
Observability and Linux: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik, cert-manager (TLS), Linux
Scripting and data: Python, Bash, SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Git, Java (test code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021-Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration, and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies, and moving end-to-end tests to on-demand ephemeral environments.
- Built merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts deployed to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; cluster operations are owned by the platform team.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed test data in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards for flaky-test metrics.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, which is used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023-2024

- Set up short-lived environments for merge requests, with the application, PostgreSQL, and seeded data deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Automated environment teardown after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature reviews and end-to-end tests.

- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal project | 2024-2025

- Ran a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching, and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)